Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on September 13, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	R. Tyler Morin
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
	Councillors	A. Khan
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier
Regrets:	Regional Councillor	J. Dies

1. Call to Order

Chair Tyler Morin called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on June 14, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on June 14, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 4.7, 4.10 and 4.11 for discussion.

Moved by: A. Khan

That items 4.8, 4.9, 4.12 and 4.13 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 CAO-2021-04: Creative Placemaking and Mural Installations

Committee Members asked questions regarding pride crosswalk locations, liability, project costs, design elements, sponsorship and funding opportunities, plans to collaborate with the Indigenous community on the Every Child Matters street mural, scope of the Signs of Life mural project including location, status of the request for permission to install murals on the Town's Highway 401 underpasses, and Truth and Reconciliation Day initiatives. Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, and Kassandra Cruciano, Grants, Partnerships and Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

That this report be received for information.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended by adding the following:

2. That the Pride Crosswalk project described in this report be considered as part of the 2022 capital budget process, and staff be authorized to complete its installation at Audley Recreation Centre, located at Audley Road and installed no later than May 2022 prior to Pride Month in June;

3. That the Signs of Life mural project B described in this report be approved and funded from the Capital Contingency Reserve, and staff be authorized to complete its installation; and

4. That staff be directed to work with the Indigenous community to identify future location requirements for an Every Child Matters street mural in Ward 3, and report back to Council in January of 2022.

CARRIED

Staff sought clarification on funding and project timelines outlined in the amendment. Robert Gruber, Manager of Community & Cultural Development and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That this report be received for information;

2. That the Pride Crosswalk project described in this report be considered as part of the 2022 capital budget process, and staff be authorized to complete its installation at Audley Recreation Centre, located at Audley Road and installed no later than May 2022 prior to Pride Month in June;

3. That the Signs of Life mural project B described in this report be approved and funded from the Capital Contingency Reserve, and staff be authorized to complete its installation; and

4. That staff be directed to work with the Indigenous community to identify future location requirements for an Every Child Matters street mural in Ward 3, and report back to Council in January of 2022.

CARRIED

4.2 FIN-2021-12: Insurance Renewal – July 1, 2021 to June 30, 2022

Committee Members sought clarification regarding the funds being transferred from capital account 992811 to the insurance reserve, inquiring if a project was cancelled or if the funds were unused, and if the balance should be allocated to the IT strategy. D. Valentim, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report on the Insurance Renewal – July 1, 2021 to June 30, 2022 be received for information;

2. That the 2021 dividend of $111,402 be transferred to the insurance reserve.

3. That Council approve the 2020 transfer of $181,937.35 to the insurance reserve from the closing of the Unbudgeted Capital Project 992811 – Risk Management.

CARRIED

4.3 FIN-2021-13: 2020 Library Operating Surplus Update

Committee Members asked questions regarding the status of the revised library reserve policy report. D. Valentim and Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That this report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.4 LIS-2021-12: Updated Clean Community By-law

Committee Members asked questions regarding enforcement, proper storage of garbage,

and remedies to mitigate public dumping. Derek Hannan, Manager of By-law Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed Clean Community By-law (ATT-1) be submitted to Council for approval at a future meeting.

CARRIED

4.5 **LIS-2021-13: Updated Exotic Pet By-law**

Committee Members asked questions regarding the number of municipalities that permit chickens in urban areas, livestock permissions, medical exemptions for service animals, public nuisance concerns, correlation between rat infestations and backyard chickens, and opportunities to implement a pilot project for an urban backyard chicken program. D. Hannan responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: L. Bower

That the proposed Exotic Pet By-law (ATT-1) be presented to Council at a future meeting for approval.

Amendment

Moved by: L. Bower

That the motion be amended by adding the following:

2. That staff be directed to bring forward a proposal and options for implementing an 'urban backyard chicken' pilot program, and report back to Council or the appropriate Standing Committee no later than the end of winter 2021.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the proposed Exotic Pet By-law (ATT-1) be presented to Council at a future meeting for approval; and

2. That staff be directed to bring forward a proposal and options for implementing an 'urban backyard chicken' pilot program, and report back to Council or the appropriate Standing Committee no later than the end of winter 2021.

CARRIED

4.6 **LIS-2021-11: Updated Kennel By-law**

Committee Members sought clarification regarding the scope of the by-law. D. Hannan, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed Kennel By-law (ATT-1) be submitted to Council at a future meeting for approval.

CARRIED

4.7 LIS-2021-10: Updated Pet Shop By-law

Committee Members asked questions regarding the number of pet shops that sell animals in Ajax, and the types of animals that are sold. D. Hannan responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed Pet Shop By-law (ATT-1) be submitted to Council at a future meeting for approval.

CARRIED

4.8 LIS-2021-09: Contract Award – Durham Region – Microsoft Licences

Moved by: A. Khan

1. That Council award the contract for Microsoft licences, to the Region of Durham in the estimated amount of $266,537.26 (net of the HST rebate), for a period of one year.

2. That Council authorize Staff to renew the contract for an additional two, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $533,000 (net of the HST rebate).

3. That Council provide pre-budget approval in the amount of $215,000 to be included in the 2022 Technology and Innovation operating budget.

CARRIED

4.9 LIS-2021-08: 2022 Council & Committee Meeting Schedule

Moved by: A. Khan

That the 2022 Meeting Schedule and Committee Chair and Vice-Chair appointments included as ATT-1 to this report be approved.

CARRIED

4.10 PDS-2021-34: Assumption of Subdivisions 18T-98014 Medallion Phase 1 (Pond Block 201 only)

Committee Members asked questions regarding timing of the assumption, future maintenance costs, stormwater maintenance fees, size of the development to the east, and if the Town is responsible for ongoing maintenance. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, Stephen Ruddy, Manager of Development Engineering and Transportation Planning, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the works and services within the following Plans of Subdivision be assumed by the Town:

   a) (18T-98014) – Medallion Phase 1 (Pond Block 201 only)
   Owner: Medallion Developments (Castlefields) Ltd.
   Agreement Date: August 29, 2003
   Registered Plan: 40M-2174
   Refer to Appendix "A"

2. That the corresponding Assumption By-laws be prepared for an upcoming Council meeting.

CARRIED

4.11 PDS-2021-35: Status of Community Improvement Plan (CIP) Applications

Michael Sawchuck, Senior Planner, noted that the Community Improvement Plan (CIP) programs have been suspended in order to conduct a comprehensive review to ascertain if the CIPs are advantageous to the Town. M. Sawchuck discussed the status of CIP applications, approved applications, and benefits of fulfilling incentives for approved applications. Committee Members asked if the Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant programs continue to generate development interest and what costs are associated with the developments. M. Sawchuck responded to Committee Members.

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended in order to hear an unscheduled delegation.

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

Steve Edwards, Planning Lead, GHD, and Larry Macdonell, 702153 Ontario Ltd., discussed the subject site (113 Old Kingston Road, Ajax), building design, status of planning approvals, soil contamination, and extraordinary development costs associated with the contamination. Committee Members sought clarification regarding site location and when the purchaser became aware of the soil contamination. Committee Members asked questions regarding soil testing, due diligence, depth of contamination levels and public risk. L. Macdonell responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That staff be authorized to coordinate the delivery of financial incentives to the following applicants based upon the pre-suspension criteria of the Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan:

   a. SP9/16 – 599 Kingston Road West – Morex Construction Inc (First Avenue);
   b. SP12/16 – 113 Old Kingston Road – Fairgate Homes; and
   c. SPA10/18 – 33 Church Street South – All Nations Full Gospel Church.

2. That staff be authorized to accept CIP applications using modified application forms (Attachments 1 & 2) on an interim basis during program suspensions to aid in the prioritization of applications should one or both of the CIP programs be reactivated in the future.

CARRIED

4.12 OES-2021-08: Contract Award - Catchbasin Cleaning Maintenance

Moved by: A. Khan

That the report on the contract award to 416 Vactors Inc. in the amount of $754,412.09 (inclusive of all taxes) for Catchbasin Cleaning Maintenance, for a period of up to three years, be received for information.

CARRIED

4.13 OES-2021-09: Contract Award – ACC – Replace 7 Domestic Hot Water & Heating Boiler (Instal.)

Moved by: A. Khan

1. That the report on the contract award to Ainsworth Inc., in the amount of $504,469.29 (inclusive of all taxes) for the ACC – Replace 7 Domestic Hot Water & Heating Boiler (Instal.), be received for information.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

5.1 PDS-2021-36: Harwood Avenue North and Haskell Avenue Pedestrian Crossing Update

Committee Members asked questions regarding opportunities to install a dedicated south bound left turn signal to reduce traffic congestion, justifications for reducing the west side corner radius, proximity to the bus stop, project timelines, next steps, design elements, remedies to alleviate obstructed sight lines, opportunities to reuse infrastructure that is encumbered by the road widening, timelines associated with the environmental assessment for Harwood Avenue North, and construction timelines. John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the report entitled “Harwood Avenue North and Haskell Avenue Pedestrian Crossing Update” be received for information.

CARRIED

6. Presentations

None

Closed Session (2:49 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session (2:49 p.m.)

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2)(d) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss a matter pertaining to labour relations or employee negotiations.

CARRIED

7.1 **Ajax Fire Association Grievance**

Open Meeting (4:41 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In-Camera

Moved by: L. Bower

That all directions approved during the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (4:42 p.m.)

Moved by: A. Khan

That the September 13, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED